LEAD LIKE A GIRL

A Leadership Workbook
for Girls Ages 10-15

Daniel Tesfamariam

LEAD LIKE A GIRL

Author: Daniel Tesfamariam

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

Ch 1: What Is Leadership (It’s Not About Being Bossy)

Ch 2: Finding Your Leadership Style

Ch 3: Communication With Confidence

Ch 4: Public Speaking for Girls

Ch 5: Building Your Team

Ch 6: Making Tough Decisions

Ch 7: Handling Disagreements

Ch 8: Leading in School

Ch 9: Starting a Club or Project

Ch 10: Social Media Leadership

Ch 11: Women Leaders Who Inspire

Ch 12: Your Leadership Action Plan

Chapter 1

WHAT IS LEADERSHIP (IT’S NOT ABOUT BEING BOSSY)

REAL GIRL LEADER STORY

Emma ran for class president and was called ’bossy’ by a boy who was praised for the same behavior as ’assertive.’ She learned that leadership means inspiring others, not controlling them. True leaders serve their communities.

SKILL BREAKDOWN

Leadership is influence, not authority. You lead when you inspire someone to do something positive they would not have done without you. You already lead in ways you may not recognize - in friendships, in family dynamics, in classrooms.

WEEKLY CHALLENGE

Identify 3 moments this week where you influenced someone positively. Those are leadership moments.

What Is Leadership (It’s Not About Being Bossy) - Scenario Practice

SCENARIO: Imagine you are leading a group project and...

one team member is not doing their share. How do you handle it?

CONFIDENCE BUILDER:

Rate your leadership confidence today (1-10): ___

One thing that would increase it by 1 point:

What Is Leadership (It’s Not About Being Bossy) - My Leadership Journal

How I practiced leadership this week:

What I learned about myself as a leader:

What Is Leadership (It’s Not About Being Bossy) - Going Deeper

Leadership in the area of what is leadership (it’s not about being bossy) requires daily practice and intentional growth. The best leaders never stop learning, never stop listening, and never stop pushing themselves to grow beyond their comfort zones.

My leadership role models for this skill:

Resources I want to explore:

Chapter 2

FINDING YOUR LEADERSHIP STYLE

REAL GIRL LEADER STORY

There is no single way to lead. Some leaders are loud and charismatic. Others are quiet and lead by example. Some lead through ideas. Others through empathy. The best leaders know their own style and use it authentically.

SKILL BREAKDOWN

Leadership styles: Visionary (big picture dreamer), Coach (develops others), Democratic (includes everyone), Pace-Setting (leads by example), Commanding (decisive in crisis), Caring (leads with empathy). Most people blend 2-3 styles.

WEEKLY CHALLENGE

Take the leadership style quiz: Are you more ideas or people focused? Do you prefer planning or action? Are you energized by groups or one-on-one?

Finding Your Leadership Style - Scenario Practice

SCENARIO: Imagine you are leading a group project and...

one team member is not doing their share. How do you handle it?

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Finding Your Leadership Style - My Leadership Journal

How I practiced leadership this week:

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Finding Your Leadership Style - Going Deeper

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Chapter 3

COMMUNICATION WITH CONFIDENCE

REAL GIRL LEADER STORY

Aisha had brilliant ideas but whispered them. Her friend repeated them louder and got credit. Communication is not just about having good ideas - it is about expressing them clearly enough that people hear and respect them.

SKILL BREAKDOWN

Confident communication: make eye contact, speak at a volume everyone can hear, use pauses instead of filler words (um, like), state your ideas clearly ('I think we should...' not 'this is probably dumb but...'), and listen as well as you speak.

WEEKLY CHALLENGE

Practice: Give a 2-minute speech to your mirror about something you believe in. Record it. Watch it. Notice your body language, volume, and clarity.

Communication With Confidence - Scenario Practice

SCENARIO: Imagine you are leading a group project and...

one team member is not doing their share. How do you handle it?

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Communication With Confidence - Going Deeper

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Chapter 4

PUBLIC SPEAKING FOR GIRLS

REAL GIRL LEADER STORY

The #1 fear in the world is public speaking. But every great leader must speak to groups. The good news: public speaking is a SKILL, not a talent. It can be learned and practiced. Every expert speaker was once terrified.

SKILL BREAKDOWN

Tips: prepare thoroughly (know your material), practice out loud (not just in your head), start with a hook (question, story, or surprising fact), make eye contact with friendly faces, use your nervous energy as enthusiasm, breathe deeply before starting.

WEEKLY CHALLENGE

Write and deliver a 3-minute speech about something you care about. Present it to your family. Notice: what was scary and what felt powerful?

Public Speaking for Girls - Scenario Practice

SCENARIO: Imagine you are leading a group project and...

one team member is not doing their share. How do you handle it?

CONFIDENCE BUILDER:

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Public Speaking for Girls - My Leadership Journal

How I practiced leadership this week:

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Public Speaking for Girls - Going Deeper

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Chapter 5

BUILDING YOUR TEAM

REAL GIRL LEADER STORY

No leader succeeds alone. Great leaders build teams where everyone’s strengths complement each other. Your job is not to do everything - it is to bring together people who together can do anything.

SKILL BREAKDOWN

Team building: identify what each person is great at and assign tasks accordingly, celebrate individual contributions publicly, handle conflict directly and fairly, make everyone feel valued and included, and share credit generously.

WEEKLY CHALLENGE

Think of a project you want to accomplish. Who would be on your dream team? What would each person contribute?

Building Your Team - Scenario Practice

SCENARIO: Imagine you are leading a group project and...

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Building Your Team - Going Deeper

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Chapter 6

MAKING TOUGH DECISIONS

REAL GIRL LEADER STORY

Leadership means sometimes choosing between two imperfect options and living with the consequences. It means deciding when others are paralyzed. Indecision is also a decision - usually a bad one.

SKILL BREAKDOWN

Decision framework: 1) Gather information, 2) Consider who is affected, 3) Think about long-term vs short-term impact, 4) Make the call, 5) Communicate clearly, 6) Own the outcome. You will not always be right, but being decisive builds trust.

WEEKLY CHALLENGE

Think of a decision you avoided making. Use the framework above. What would you decide? What stopped you before?

Making Tough Decisions - Scenario Practice

SCENARIO: Imagine you are leading a group project and...

one team member is not doing their share. How do you handle it?

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Making Tough Decisions - My Leadership Journal

How I practiced leadership this week:

What I learned about myself as a leader:

Making Tough Decisions - Going Deeper

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My leadership role models for this skill:

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Chapter 7

HANDLING DISAGREEMENTS

REAL GIRL LEADER STORY

Conflict is inevitable in leadership. Someone will disagree with you, challenge you, or work against you. How you handle disagreement defines your leadership character more than how you handle agreement.

SKILL BREAKDOWN

Conflict resolution: listen first (really listen, do not just wait to talk), acknowledge the other person's perspective, find common ground, compromise where possible, stand firm where necessary, and never attack the person - address the issue.

WEEKLY CHALLENGE

Recall a disagreement you had. How did you handle it? Using the strategies above, how could you have handled it better?

Handling Disagreements - Scenario Practice

SCENARIO: Imagine you are leading a group project and...

one team member is not doing their share. How do you handle it?

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Handling Disagreements - My Leadership Journal

How I practiced leadership this week:

What I learned about myself as a leader:

Handling Disagreements - Going Deeper

Leadership in the area of handling disagreements requires daily practice and intentional growth. The best leaders never stop learning, never stop listening, and never stop pushing themselves to grow beyond their comfort zones.

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Chapter 8

LEADING IN SCHOOL

REAL GIRL LEADER STORY

You do not have to wait until adulthood to lead. School offers leadership opportunities every day: group projects, student council, sports teams, clubs, tutoring, organizing events, standing up for classmates.

SKILL BREAKDOWN

Ways to lead at school NOW: volunteer to present first, help classmates who are struggling, organize study groups, start a club about something you care about, run for student government, mentor younger students, speak up against bullying.

WEEKLY CHALLENGE

Set a school leadership goal for this month. What will you do? Who will benefit? How will you measure success?

Leading in School - Scenario Practice

SCENARIO: Imagine you are leading a group project and...

one team member is not doing their share. How do you handle it?

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Leading in School - My Leadership Journal

How I practiced leadership this week:

What I learned about myself as a leader:

Leading in School - Going Deeper

Leadership in the area of leading in school requires daily practice and intentional growth. The best leaders never stop learning, never stop listening, and never stop pushing themselves to grow beyond their comfort zones.

My leadership role models for this skill:

Resources I want to explore:

Chapter 9

STARTING A CLUB OR PROJECT

REAL GIRL LEADER STORY

The best way to develop leadership is to lead something real. Starting a club, project, or initiative teaches you planning, communication, team building, problem-solving, and perseverance - all in a low-stakes environment.

SKILL BREAKDOWN

Steps to start: 1) Identify your cause/interest, 2) Find 2-3 interested people, 3) Create a simple mission statement, 4) Get adult sponsor/approval, 5) Set first meeting, 6) Create structure (roles, schedule), 7) Take your first action, 8) Grow and adjust.

WEEKLY CHALLENGE

What cause, hobby, or issue would you start a club about? Draft a mission statement and list of potential members.

Starting a Club or Project - Scenario Practice

SCENARIO: Imagine you are leading a group project and...

one team member is not doing their share. How do you handle it?

CONFIDENCE BUILDER:

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One thing that would increase it by 1 point:

Starting a Club or Project - My Leadership Journal

How I practiced leadership this week:

What I learned about myself as a leader:

Starting a Club or Project - Going Deeper

Leadership in the area of starting a club or project requires daily practice and intentional growth. The best leaders never stop learning, never stop listening, and never stop pushing themselves to grow beyond their comfort zones.

My leadership role models for this skill:

Resources I want to explore:

Chapter 10

SOCIAL MEDIA LEADERSHIP

REAL GIRL LEADER STORY

Social media gives you a platform to lead that previous generations never had. You can raise awareness, organize events, build communities, and inspire followers. But online leadership requires wisdom and responsibility.

SKILL BREAKDOWN

Social media leadership: stand for something (not everything), be consistent, engage authentically, use your platform for good, do not engage with trolls, protect your mental health, fact-check before sharing, and remember that your digital presence is your reputation.

WEEKLY CHALLENGE

Create a vision for your social media presence: What do you want to be known for? What value will you provide your followers?

Social Media Leadership - Scenario Practice

SCENARIO: Imagine you are leading a group project and...

one team member is not doing their share. How do you handle it?

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Social Media Leadership - My Leadership Journal

How I practiced leadership this week:

What I learned about myself as a leader:

Social Media Leadership - Going Deeper

Leadership in the area of social media leadership requires daily practice and intentional growth. The best leaders never stop learning, never stop listening, and never stop pushing themselves to grow beyond their comfort zones.

My leadership role models for this skill:

Resources I want to explore:

Chapter 11

WOMEN LEADERS WHO INSPIRE

REAL GIRL LEADER STORY

Throughout history, women have led movements, nations, companies, and communities against incredible odds. Their stories prove that feminine leadership qualities like empathy, collaboration, and emotional intelligence are superpowers.

SKILL BREAKDOWN

Inspiring leaders: Jacinda Ardern (compassion), Michelle Obama (authenticity), Malala (courage), Greta Thunberg (conviction), Oprah (connection), Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez (boldness), Brene Brown (vulnerability as strength).

WEEKLY CHALLENGE

Choose one woman leader to research deeply. What specific leadership qualities does she demonstrate? How can you develop those same qualities?

Women Leaders Who Inspire - Scenario Practice

SCENARIO: Imagine you are leading a group project and...

one team member is not doing their share. How do you handle it?

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Women Leaders Who Inspire - My Leadership Journal

How I practiced leadership this week:

What I learned about myself as a leader:

Women Leaders Who Inspire - Going Deeper

Leadership in the area of women leaders who inspire requires daily practice and intentional growth. The best leaders never stop learning, never stop listening, and never stop pushing themselves to grow beyond their comfort zones.

My leadership role models for this skill:

Resources I want to explore:

Chapter 12

YOUR LEADERSHIP ACTION PLAN

REAL GIRL LEADER STORY

Leadership is not something you learn once - it is something you practice daily. This final chapter helps you create a concrete plan for developing your leadership skills over the next 12 months.

SKILL BREAKDOWN

Your plan should include: one leadership book to read each month, one new leadership challenge weekly, a mentor to learn from, a regular reflection practice, and a big leadership goal for the year. Track your growth and celebrate progress.

WEEKLY CHALLENGE

Complete the Leadership Action Plan template on the next page. Share it with a mentor or accountability partner.

Your Leadership Action Plan - Scenario Practice

SCENARIO: Imagine you are leading a group project and...

one team member is not doing their share. How do you handle it?

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Your Leadership Action Plan - My Leadership Journal

How I practiced leadership this week:

What I learned about myself as a leader:

Your Leadership Action Plan - Going Deeper

Leadership in the area of your leadership action plan requires daily practice and intentional growth. The best leaders never stop learning, never stop listening, and never stop pushing themselves to grow beyond their comfort zones.

My leadership role models for this skill:

Resources I want to explore:

MY LEADERSHIP ACTION PLAN

My Leadership Vision:

My Leadership Style:

My 3-Month Goals:

My 12-Month Goal:

My Accountability Partner:

The world needs YOUR leadership.

Lead like a girl. That is a compliment.

NOTES & REFLECTIONS

Use this space for additional thoughts and ideas:

PERSONAL GROWTH JOURNAL

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My commitment:

REFLECTION & ACTION STEPS

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Actions I will take:

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How this applies to my life:

Questions I still have:

NOTES & REFLECTIONS

Use this space for additional thoughts and ideas:

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Actions I will take:

My commitment:

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DEEPER EXPLORATION

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GROWTH JOURNAL

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